

FINAL FANTASY IV

ENGLISH INSTRUCTION MANUAL

Dark Chapter • Light Chapter • Final Chapter

Beta 1.1 | Updated November 1, 2026

Preface

Welcome to Final Fantasy IV. This booklet brings the Dark, Light and Final Chapters together in one guide to the English NES release. Read the starting instructions before beginning, then follow the walkthrough for your chosen chapter.

Use an emulator that supports this release: NES 2.0 mapper 342 (COOLGIRL), with 32 KiB battery-backed save memory. The release was tested with PC FCEUmm. The emulator's controller settings determine which keyboard or controller buttons correspond to A, B and START.

Contents

Dark Chapter / 4

Starting Menu • Controls • Story Summary
Walkthrough • Game Locations • Game Menu
Battle Menu • Gameplay Tips

Light Chapter / 11

Starting Menu • Controls • Story Summary
Walkthrough • Game Locations • Game Menu
Battle Menu • Gameplay Tips

Final Chapter / 18

Starting Menu • Controls • Story Summary
Walkthrough • Game Locations • Game Menu
Battle Menu • Gameplay Tips

Chapter selection and saving — 3

Beta 1.1 restores the full GIL display above the party and extends the command panel. Location popups use short names (for example, Baron Keep = Baron Castle). Walkthrough names still refer to the same places.

Starting your journey



The combined release opens here.

Use **Up/Down** to choose a chapter. Press **A or START** to launch it, then choose **NEW GAME** or **LOAD GAME** on that chapter's title screen. Play the chapters in order for the complete story.

Saving and changing chapters

On the field, press **START**, move down to **SAVE**, and press **A**. To return to chapter selection, use your emulator's **Reset/Restart** command. Reset does not save unsaved progress.

Each chapter keeps its own save. Select the same chapter and choose **LOAD GAME** to resume. Starting another chapter gives you that chapter's starting party and supplies; levels and equipment do not transfer between chapters. Keep the emulator's battery-save file with the game.

Dark Chapter

Starting menu



NEW GAME / LOAD GAME

NEW GAME: Begin this chapter with its own starting party and supplies.
LOAD GAME: Continue this chapter from its saved record. Use Up/Down to choose, then A to confirm. See page 3 for saving and changing chapters.

Controls

Direction pad: Move on the map or move the menu cursor.
START: Begin a new game from the title screen; open the game menu on the field.
A: Confirm choices, interact and advance dialogue. Some scenes begin when you approach a person or enter a doorway.
B: Back out of a menu or close the field menu.

Story summary

Cecil, captain of Baron's Red Wings, has obeyed an order he cannot forgive. The Water Crystal has been taken from Mysidia by force. When he questions his king, Cecil loses his command and is sent with the dragoon Kain to deliver a mysterious package to the village of Mist. What begins as a royal errand will become a journey to cast off the darkness.

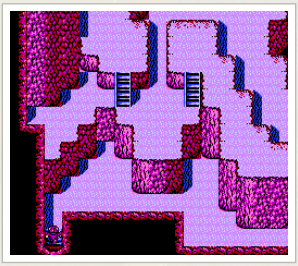
Walkthrough

1. Baron Castle

Cecil returns to Baron after seizing Mysidia's Crystal. His doubts anger the king, who dismisses him from the Red Wings. Kain speaks up for him. The two are sent to deliver a package to Mist. Visit the castle, speak to Rosa and Cid, and rest before leaving.

2. Mist Cave

Travel to the cave northwest of Baron. Follow the winding bridges and passages, defeat the creature guarding the exit and continue toward Mist.



The passage through Mist Cave

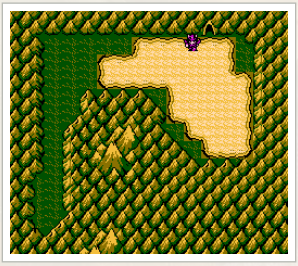
3. Mist Village

The package releases fire into the village. Cecil discovers what his mission has done. Rydia's power separates Cecil from Kain; after the disaster, Cecil takes responsibility for protecting her.

Walkthrough

4. Rydia and Rosa

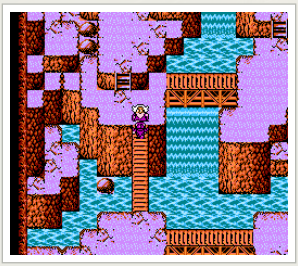
After the disaster at Mist, continue the roadside scenes with Rydia. Baron's soldiers have captured Rosa and demand that Cecil surrender the girl. Defeat the soldiers and finish the conversation. Rosa has been poisoned; Rydia suggests seeking the Sand Ruby. Continue toward the underground waterway.



After the ambush

5. The waterway

Enter the waterway and meet Tellah, who is searching for his daughter Anna. Follow the bridges and stairs, completing the resting-place conversation. Continue through the waterfall route, defeat its guardian and leave toward Damcyan.

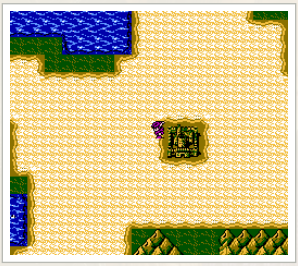


The waterway

Walkthrough

6. Damcyan in the desert

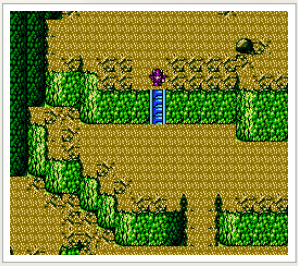
Enter the castle after Baron's attack. Complete the Anna, Tellah and Edward scenes. Edward gives Cecil the Sand Ruby; it restores Rosa, and Edward joins the party. Continue to Mount Hobs.



Approaching Damcyan

7. Go to Fabul

Cross Mount Hobs. Rydia uses Fire to clear the ice. Help Yang, then accompany him to Fabul and speak to the king. Follow the defense and kidnapping scenes. Rest at the inn, finish the recovery conversations, then take the route to the port and speak to the sailor.



Mount Hobs

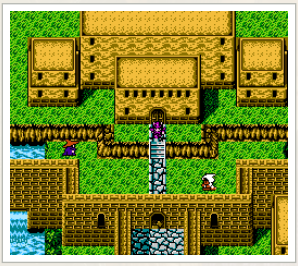


The king of Fabul

Walkthrough

8. Mysidia

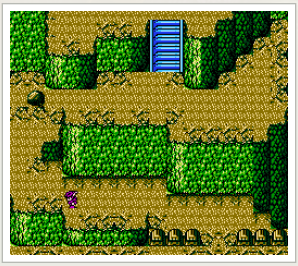
The sea voyage ends in disaster, and Cecil comes to Mysidia. Seek the elder in the tower. To abandon the dark sword, Cecil must climb Mount Ordeals. The young mages Palom and Porom join him for the trial.



Speak to Mysidia's elder

9. Mount Ordeals

Climb the mountain and use the party's magic to overcome the obstacles. Tellah joins the journey again. Defeat the enemies guarding the summit and enter the place of trial. Cecil must face his own darkness before he can become a paladin.



The climb to the summit

Game locations

Where available, visit an **inn** to rest, a **weapon or armor shop** for equipment, and an **item shop** for supplies. Speak to the attendant and follow the choices offered.

Game menu



The menu shows the party and its commands.

ITEM: View your inventory.
MAGIC: Choose a character to view available spells and their MP costs.
EQUIP: Choose a character to manage weapons and armor.
STATS: Check attributes, experience and equipment.
SAVE: Record progress for this chapter's LOAD GAME.
Use A to select a command and, when prompted, a character. B returns to the preceding menu.

HP is health; MP powers magic. GIL is money and appears above the party portraits.

Battle menu



Choose commands during the defense of Fabul.

Fight: Choose a normal attack.
Magc: Choose magic available to the character.
Item: Choose an item to use.
Run: Attempt to escape. Do not rely on escape to bypass a required encounter.
Follow the cursor through command and target selection, confirming with A.

Gameplay tips

Finish conversations with the people involved in your current task. Check the party and its supplies after recruitment or departure scenes. Save before setting off on a long journey. If a route is blocked, return to the person who gave you the task and complete the next conversation.

Use the options shown by the game when choosing spells, equipment and battle actions.

Light Chapter

Starting menu



NEW GAME / LOAD GAME

NEW GAME: Begin this chapter with its own starting party and supplies.
LOAD GAME: Continue this chapter from its saved record. Use Up/Down to choose, then A to confirm. See page 3 for saving and changing chapters.

Controls

Direction pad: Move on the map or move the menu cursor.
START: Begin a new game from the title screen; open the game menu on the field.
A: Confirm choices, interact and advance dialogue. Some scenes begin when you approach a person or enter a doorway.
B: Back out of a menu or close the field menu.

Story summary

Cecil has put aside the dark sword and become a paladin. But Baron still threatens the world, Rosa remains in danger, and Golbez pursues the Crystals. With Tellah and the twins at his side, Cecil returns to his homeland to discover what has become of its king. The trail leads from Baron to Troia, the Lodestone Cavern and the Tower of Zot.

Walkthrough

1. Return to Baron

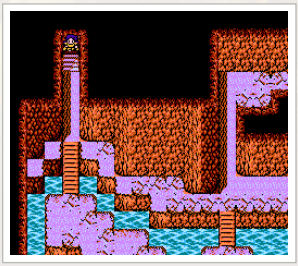
Cecil has become a paladin. Return to Baron with the companions who accompanied him from Mysidia. Find Yang, complete the encounter with him and obtain the Baron Key. The key opens the way to the old waterway.



Cecil begins this chapter as a paladin

The route into the castle

Pass through the underground waterway and emerge behind the castle. Explore the corridors and make your way toward the royal chambers.



The waterway



The castle's rear entrance

Walkthrough

2. Baron Castle

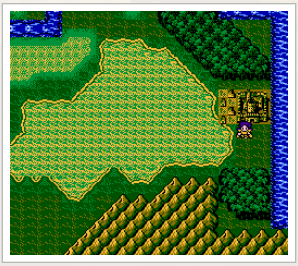
Baigan appears to offer his help, but the party discovers the truth. Defeat him and continue to the throne room. The king is an impostor: Cagnazzo, one of Golbez's four fiends. Defeat him to free Baron from his rule.



Baigan reveals himself

After the battle

The enemy's final trap threatens the party. Palom and Porom sacrifice themselves to stop the walls. Cid helps the others escape. Follow the next conversations to learn the price demanded for Rosa's release and the importance of Troia's Earth Crystal.

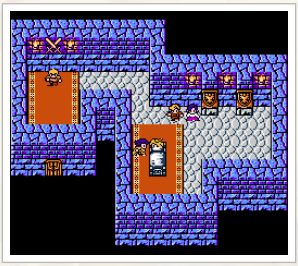


Continue from Baron toward Troia

Walkthrough

3. The stolen Earth Crystal

At Troia, speak to the clerics and learn that the Dark Elf has stolen the Earth Crystal. Visit Edward, wounded after the shipwreck. His Twin Harp will help the party inside the magnetic cavern.



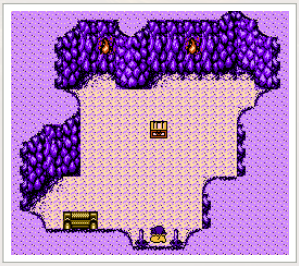
Edward and the Twin Harp

Find the correct travel point

Pay attention to the transfer points on the world map: the correct one leads toward the Lodestone Cavern. Follow the cave's passages to the Dark Elf. Edward's music breaks the enemy's advantage. Defate the Dark Elf, recover the Crystal and return to Troia.



Travel point to the cavern

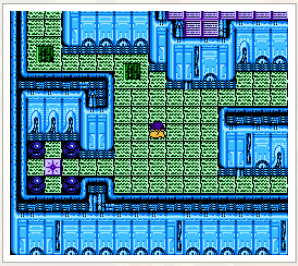


Follow the cave passages

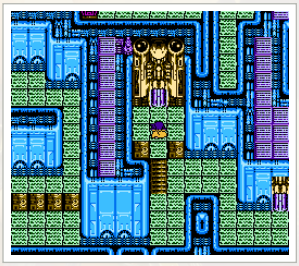
Walkthrough

4. Return to Troia; enter Zot

Report to the clerics after recovering the Crystal. Kain appears and directs the party toward the Tower of Zot. Follow the route through the tower and defeat the three sisters guarding its upper rooms.



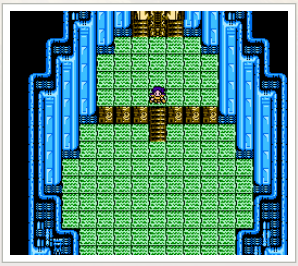
The Tower of Zot



The sisters' chamber

Rosa's rescue

Tellah attacks Golbez with Meteor, spending his remaining strength. Golbez withdraws, and Kain comes to his senses. Rescue Rosa, then face Barbariccia, the fiend of wind. After the escape, the next task is revealed: Golbez also seeks the Dark Crystals beneath the earth.



Rescue Rosa and regroup

Game locations

Where available, visit an **inn** to rest, a **weapon or armor shop** for equipment, and an **item shop** for supplies. Speak to the attendant and follow the choices offered.

Game menu



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Battle menu



The final confrontation with Barbariccia.

Fight: Choose a normal attack.
Magc: Choose magic available to the character.
Item: Choose an item to use.
Run: Attempt to escape. Do not rely on escape to bypass a required encounter.
Follow the cursor through command and target selection, confirming with A.

Gameplay tips

Finish conversations with the people involved in your current task. Check the party and its supplies after recruitment or departure scenes. Save before setting off on a long journey. If a route is blocked, return to the person who gave you the task and complete the next conversation.

Use the options shown by the game when choosing spells, equipment and battle actions.

Final Chapter

Starting menu



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Controls

Direction pad: Move on the map or move the menu cursor.
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Story summary

Cecil and his companions have reached the Underworld, where the dwarves struggle against Golbez's forces. The enemy already holds most of the Crystals. King Giott offers help, but even his hidden Crystal chamber is in danger. The last stage of the journey leads through Babil and the Sealed Cave, then onward to the moon and the source of the darkness.

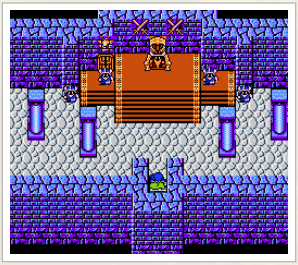
Walkthrough

1. Background

The party has reached the world beneath the surface. Golbez seeks the Dark Crystals as well as the four Crystals above. Cecil and his friends must seek the dwarves' help before the enemy obtains them all.

2. The Dwarven Kingdom

Enter Dwarven Castle and speak to its king. Cid leaves to arrange repairs to the airship. Behind the throne lies the Crystal chamber. Strange dolls attack the party, followed by Golbez. Rydia returns and helps defeat him, but Golbez escapes with the Crystal.



Speak to the dwarf king

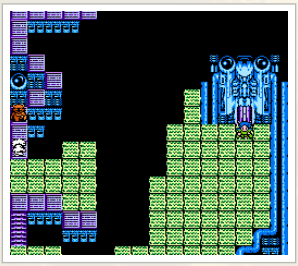
The king's request

Return to the king. He asks the party to strike at the Tower of Babil while the enemy is occupied elsewhere. The dwarven tanks will provide cover. Take the passage below the castle to reach the outside.

Walkthrough

3. The Tower of Babil

Climb Babil and confront Dr. Lugae. After the battles, return through the tower to the cannon room. Yang stays behind to stop the cannon. Retrace the lower route and cross the exit bridge to trigger the escape and Cid's rescue scenes.



A route through Babil

4. Eblan and its prince

Continue the sequence after escaping Babil. Edge confronts Rubicante and joins the party. Once field control returns, head back to the dwarven castle.

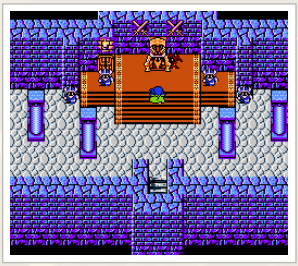


The party after Edge joins

Walkthrough

5. From Eblan to the dwarves

Speak to Giott to receive Luca's Necklace. Visit Cid in the infirmary below the castle and finish the heatproofing conversation. Both the key and the airship upgrade are needed. Leave through the castle front, board the airship outside and follow the route to the Sealed Cave.



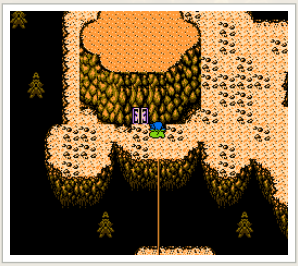
Return to Giott



Find Cid in the infirmary

6. The Sealed Cave

Follow the doors, ropes and connecting passages to the Crystal chamber. Recover the Dark Crystal, then defeat the Demon Wall. Retrace the cave route and continue the exit scenes: Kain takes the Crystal under Golbez's influence.

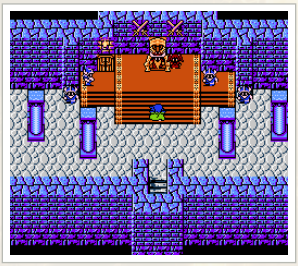


The cave's first rope and ledges

Walkthrough

7. Return to the dwarves; the moon

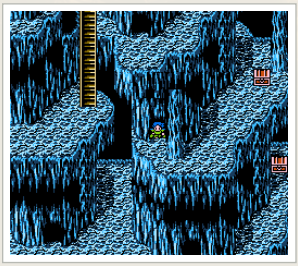
Return by the airship route and speak to Giott. Use the newly opened passage by the throne toward the Lunar Palace. Meet FuSoYa, then follow the lunar portal and altar route back toward Earth. The Giant and reunion scenes restore Kain to the party.



Giott opens the lunar route

The final passages

Continue through the Crystal Palace and speak to the guides. Descend through the ravines and lunar depths, exploring connecting platforms and exits. Rubicante guards the final approach. Defeat him, continue to Zeromus and finish the ending scenes.



The lunar passages



The final battle

Game locations

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Game menu



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Battle menu



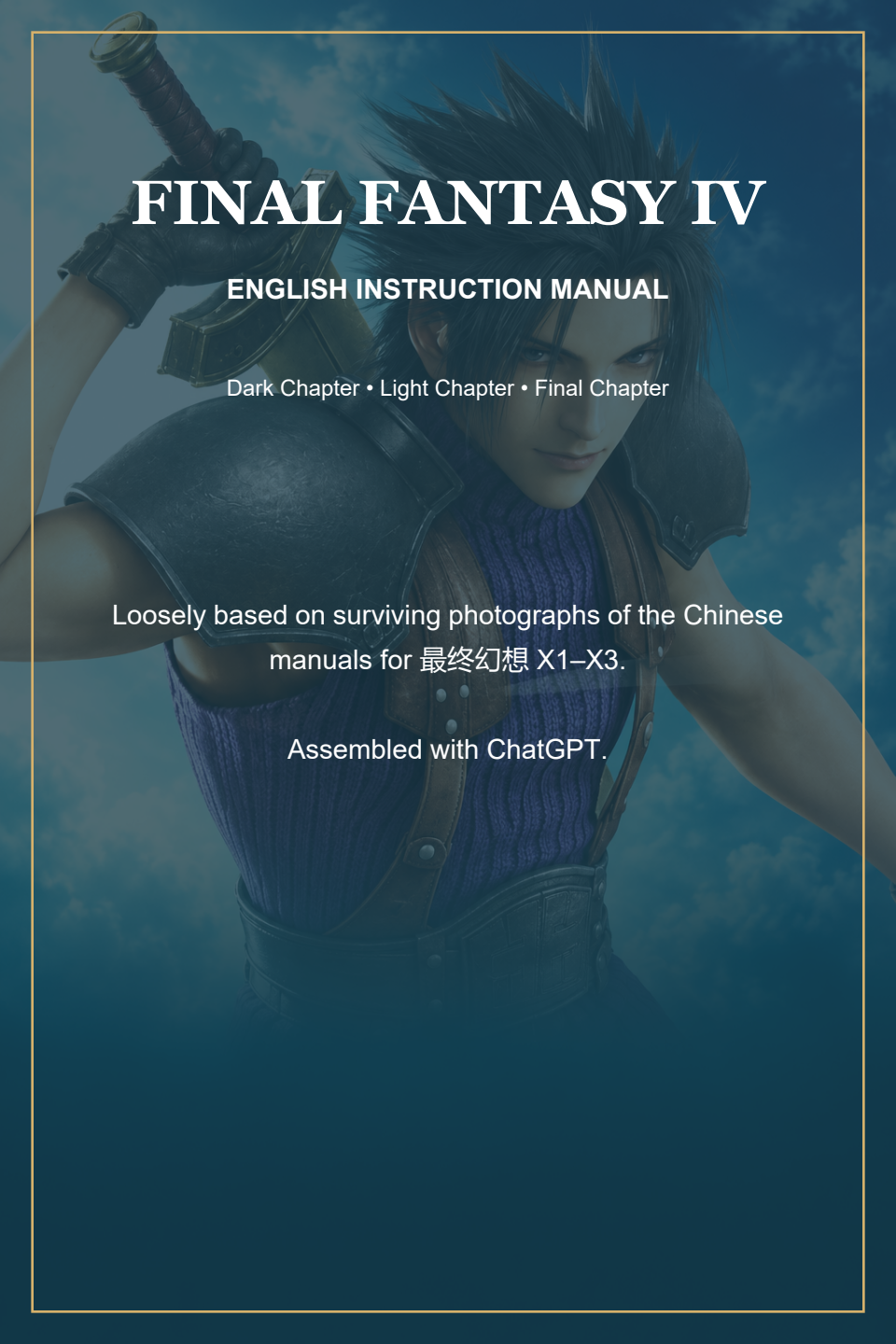
Zeromus, the final enemy.

Fight: Choose a normal attack.
Magc: Choose magic available to the character.
Item: Choose an item to use.
Run: Attempt to escape. Do not rely on escape to bypass a required encounter.
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Gameplay tips

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Use the options shown by the game when choosing spells, equipment and battle actions.



FINAL FANTASY IV

ENGLISH INSTRUCTION MANUAL

Dark Chapter • Light Chapter • Final Chapter

Loosely based on surviving photographs of the Chinese manuals for 最终幻想 X1–X3.

Assembled with ChatGPT.